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Set up a soft locking approval policy for time entries

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Objective

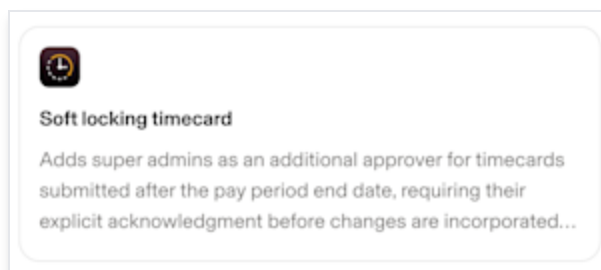
A soft locking approval policy adds super admins as an additional approver for time entries submitted after the pay period end date, requiring their explicit acknowledgment before changes are incorporated into the pay run. To prevent overlapping approvals, configure your non-soft locking approval policies with conditions that prevent them from overlapping with the soft locking approval policy.

Set up a soft locking approval policy for time entries

Note: This article provides instructions for the new Time Settings experience, which is currently available to a limited set of customers. If your experience doesn't match what's described, your account may not have been upgraded yet — navigate to **Time > Policies** instead and locate the relevant policy category. Learn more in this article, which provides an [overview of the new Time Settings experience](#).

To set up a soft locking approval policy for time entries, follow these steps:

1. From the main sidebar, select **Time**.
2. From the *Time* sidebar, select **Time Settings**.
3. Scroll to the *Attendance* section and click **Timesheet approvals**.
4. Click **+ New** to create a new policy.
5. Select the **Soft locking timecard** recipe card.



6. Click **Customize this policy**.
7. Review and edit policy settings as necessary.
8. Click **Create approval policy**.

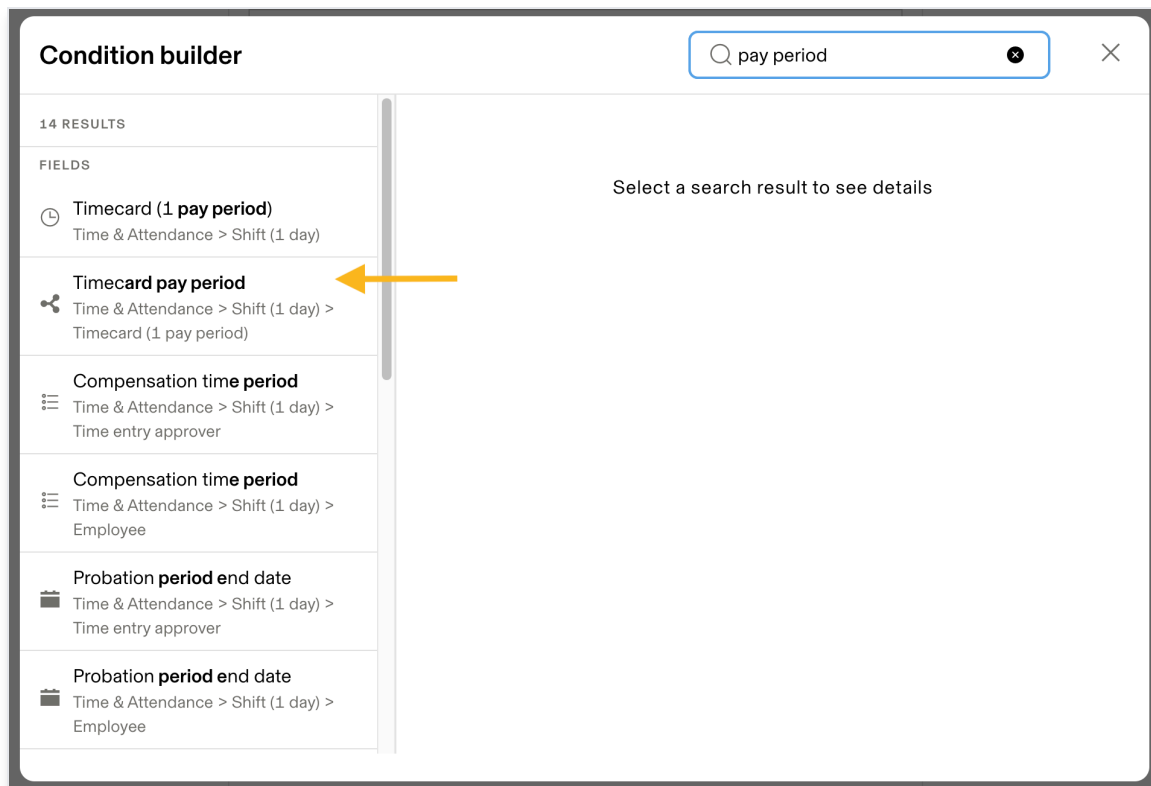
Prevent overlapping time entry approval policies

If a time tracking approval policy isn't tied to a specific pay period, it may trigger at the same time as a soft locking approval policy for late entries. To avoid this, configure your non-soft locking approval policies with conditions that prevent them from overlapping with the soft lock approval policy.

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To update an existing time entry approval policy to prevent overlapping time entry approval policies, follow these steps:

1. From the main sidebar, select **Time**.
2. From the *Time* sidebar, select **Time Settings**.
3. Scroll to the *Attendance* section and click **Timesheet approvals**.
4. Locate your existing time entry approval policy.
5. Click the **three dots icon**.
6. Select **Edit**.
7. In the *Condition* box, click + **Add condition**.
8. In the search field, enter "pay period".
9. Select **Timecard pay period**.



10. Under *Pay period attributes*, select **Pay Period End Date**.
11. For the *This condition will be met if pay period end date...* setting, select **Is after**.
12. On the *Relevant date* sub-tab, select **Today**.
13. Click **Add Condition**.
14. Click **Update approval policy**.

By applying these conditions, Rippling ensures that only the soft locking policy triggers for past periods, while the time entry approval policy triggers for current or future periods.

See also

Learn more in these related resources:

- [Overview of time entry approval policies](#)

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